RUI (ASH) FENG

ash.rui.feng@gmail.com ⋄ ashfeng.com ⋄ Nagoya, Japan

RESEARCH INTERESTS

Perceived polarization in digitally mediated environments; translating cognitive mechanisms into system-level intervention designs – implemented first in algorithmic feeds, with conversational AI as a proposed second test arena.

EDUCATION

Kansai University – Osaka, Japan 2020–2022
M.A. in Sociology (Mass Communication), GPA 4.0/4.0

Shanghai Polytechnic University – Shanghai, China 2014–2018
B.A. in English Language and Literature

University of Missouri–Kansas City – Kansas City, MO 2016
Exchange Student

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

Lichtung – Feed-Based Experimental Simulator for Perceived Polarization 2026–Present
Independent research project, sole designer and developer – lichtung.ashfeng.com – github.com/rfb4c/Lichtung

- Built a platform-independent social feed simulator that turns mechanisms of perceived polarization into manipulable feed- and interface-level experimental conditions, without dependence on commercial-platform APIs.
- Redirected the work from *what users see* to *how users interpret what they see* after retiring R-selected (2025), an earlier deployed prototype aggregating same-event coverage across outlets of differing stances, once a systematic literature review found the filter-bubble account weakly evidenced (Bruns, 2019; Arguedas et al., 2022) and cross-cutting exposure capable of backfiring (Bail et al., 2018).
- Implemented three intervention modules, each targeting a distinct documented mechanism of out-group misperception: exemplar-diversity reweighting in the ranking layer, a consensus-overlay UI carrying authoritative poll distributions, and an identity layer that lowers party-label salience.
- Extending the prototype into an RCT-capable platform: randomized condition assignment, behavioral telemetry (exposure sequence, dwell time, scroll depth, interactions), and pre/post survey linkage.

Master's Thesis Research – Kansai University, Graduate School of Sociology 2020–2022
How party-press social media built the boundaries of national community through patriotic propaganda in the early COVID-19 pandemic

- Hand-coded the complete census of 2,318 posts published by the *People's Daily* WeChat official account over the first four months of 2020, developing an original coding scheme measuring both who each post addressed and how it defined "us" when it did.
- Found attention turned sharply inward at the crisis peak, driven by which topics entered the publishing agenda rather than a shift in how existing foreign coverage was framed; outward-facing content rarely combined positive self-positioning with hostility toward outsiders.
- Found representational form assembled from a small set of reusable title formulas and narrative paths rather than composed anew for each event: hero portrayals converged on healthcare workers – from a third of represented figures to nearly nine in ten – after the first political mobilization point.

EMPLOYMENT

Accenture Japan – Nagoya, Japan July 2025–Present
AI Engineer / Consultant
Joined through the acquisition of Neutral Inc. Generative AI and AI-agent delivery, from proof of concept to production adoption.

- **AI-driven development workflow for a major energy utility** (August 2025–Present). Development lead, team of 5. Designed the AI workflow architecture and MCP integration for automated generation of Java error-handling code in a large-scale customer information system; cut a requirements-to-unit-test cycle that previously took months to 4–5 days. Received an internal MVP award.
- **Content-generation AI agent for a municipal government's international public relations division** (April–June 2026). Developer, then recovery lead; team of 10. Prompt design and implementation in Python and Strands Agents; as recovery lead on a stalled project, ran architecture review, task prioritization, ownership assignment, and progress management.
- **Generative-AI incident-response support for a central government ministry** (June–August 2025). Developer. Designed and rolled out a generative-AI debugging solution with instructional video, hands-on sessions, and internal enablement.

Neutral Inc. – Nagoya, Japan July 2023–June 2025
Software Engineer
Full-stack agile development of a vehicle design support system for a major automotive manufacturer: detailed design through implementation, unit test, and system test in Java, TypeScript, and Oracle.

The Cover (封面新闻) – Beijing, China July–November 2022
Journalist
Reported on government, science and technology, and general news; story planning, interviewing, writing, and video direction. Investigated employment discrimination against people recovering from COVID-19, prompting a policy response from the Ministry of Human Resources and Social Security. Member of the feature team covering a national infrastructure program; the series reached roughly 100 million cumulative views and later received the China News Award.

The Paper (澎湃新闻) – Shanghai, China January 2021–January 2022
Intern Journalist
Covered cultural affairs in writing, photography, and documentary video. Independently reported, shot, and edited a documentary on Chinese students in Japan during the COVID-19 pandemic.

AWARDS AND HONORS

2025, Internal MVP Award, Accenture Japan (generative-AI engagement for a major energy utility)
2023, China News Award (中国新闻奖), team award, national infrastructure feature series, The Cover

SKILLS

Research	Quantitative content analysis and qualitative close reading; coding scheme development and intercoder reliability.
Programming	Python, Java, TypeScript; full-stack web development (Spring Boot, Angular, Vue); data analysis in Python (pandas); containerized cloud deployment (Docker, AWS, Azure).
AI Systems	LLM agent development (Strands Agents, MCP); RAG with vector and graph databases; prompt and context engineering; production AI workflow design.

CERTIFICATIONS AND LANGUAGES

2026, Google Cloud Generative AI Leader
2025, AWS Certified Cloud Practitioner
2019, Japanese Language Proficiency Test, N1
Chinese (native); English (fluent); Japanese (fluent)